when IOs do successfully connect with their audiences, their messages can resonate effectively. Social media engagement is also relatively low-cost compared with other outreach methods, making it an attractive option for IOs seeking to shore up their legitimacy. Posting strategically or hiring a dedicated communications director is often a feasible investment. Given these attributes, social media campaigns should serve as one component of a multipronged strategy rather than as the sole approach to countering populist resistance.

While communicating directly with the public enhances IOs' transparency and accountability, adopting populist-style rhetoric carries its own risks. Such messaging may inadvertently raise expectations that IOs will align themselves with a populist agenda. Citizens might begin to expect that IOs reduce demands that impinge on sovereignty, integrate more non-elite voices into their operations, or even mimic populist domestic policies in other ways. For instance, Hungary's populist trajectory under Viktor Orbán has arguably pressured the EU to adopt more populist-leaning policies in response to public sentiment.

If these heightened expectations are fostered but remain unmet, IOs could face backlash, undermining their legitimacy and reinforcing populist narratives that they are undemocratic or out-of-touch with ordinary citizens' needs (Tallberg and Zürn 2019). Striking a balance between engaging public support and maintaining organizational autonomy is thus crucial.

In the next chapter, we illustrate how IOs have deployed the four strategies we have identified—appeasement, secrecy, sidelining, and public outreach—to combat populist challenges in a diverse series of real-world cases. We show that populists have sought to weaken organizations spanning several issue areas and that IOs have responded by utilizing a mix of sidelining and appeasing populists and their constituents. Doing so has helped IOs remain resilient.

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2. Elisabeth Malkin, "In Costa Rica Election, Gay-Marriage Foe Takes First Round." *New York Times*. February 5, 2018.

3. Interviews with former senior IMF officials, February 2021, and WTO officials, October 2022.

4. Kristalina Georgieva, speech at the IMF, 2019.

5. "Europa Experiences." *Visiting European Parliament*. https://visiting.europarl.europa.eu/en/visitor-offer/other-locations/europa-experience. Accessed January 15, 2024.